Tarragona — day trip itinerary

From Barcelona · with transport, hours and booking links

Check before you plan. Museums and attractions that need advance tickets may be sold out — check availability via the ticket links first. Hours are typical and change by season; many museums close on Mondays.

The former capital of Roman Hispania, with a UNESCO-listed amphitheatre overlooking the Mediterranean, a Roman circus, city walls, and a lively seafront promenade.

Before you go: check opening days and train/bus timetables, and book anything marked *Book ahead* — tickets, tours and seats may not be available on the day.

HOW TO GET THERE

Train: Direct Rodalies R16 from Barcelona-Sants (~1h15), or high-speed AVE (~35 min).

No change needed — direct service either way.

Bus: Direct coach from Barcelona Estació del Nord, about 1h30.

08:00 — **Depart Barcelona**

Direct Rodalies R16 from Barcelona-Sants (~1h15), or high-speed AVE (~35 min).

09:15 — **Roman Amphitheatre** TICKETED

A UNESCO-listed amphitheatre overlooking the Mediterranean.

🚇 5-minute walk from the station.

Book official tickets →

10:30 — **Tarragona Cathedral & old town** FREE ENTRY

A blend of Romanesque and Gothic architecture crowning the old town.

🚇 5-minute walk.

12:00 — **Passeig Arqueològic — Roman walls walk** FREE ENTRY

A walk along the city's Roman-era fortifications.

🚇 5-minute walk.

13:00 — **Lunch in the old town**

Plenty of options around the Cathedral and Rambla Nova.

14:00 — **Platja del Miracle beach, or the Roman Circus & Forum** FREE ENTRY

Beach time right below the amphitheatre, or more Roman ruins in the lower town.

16:00 — **Shopping — Rambla Nova** SHOPPING

Tarragona's main shopping street, running through the newer part of town.

17:30 — **Train back to Barcelona**

Same route in reverse.

🚇 35 minutes to 1h15.

20:00 — **Farewell dinner in Barcelona**

A last evening to round off the trip.

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